

REGULATIONS 2026

CRITERIA & ELIGIBILITY

1. Film quality: Storytelling impact and overall production quality.
2. Use of AI techniques: Creative integration of AI and effective use. The submitters must include a file in the format of PDF documenting how the film is created, including what AI tools are used, the time spent for production, AI filmmaking workflows, screenshots and pictures with corresponding instructions and explanations of filmmaking process. (PDF file links from cloud storage services such as Google Drive, Baidu Pan, OneDrive, Quark Pan, etc. are all acceptable.)
3. Duration: The films submitted to the Main Competition must be over three minutes long.
4. Language: Films that contain languages other than English must include English subtitles.
5. Films previously submitted to the past editions of the Festival will not be reconsidered.

SUBMISSION FORMATS

1. Initial Submission (for selection purposes):
 - Video format: MP4 or MOV,
 - Resolution: 1080p,
 - Codec: H.264,
 - Audio: Stereo,
 - Subtitles: Burned-in subtitles.
2. If Selected for Official Screening:
 - Resolution: Minimum 1080p, preferred 2K or 4K,
 - Audio: Stereo or 5.1 surround sound,

Selected films may be required to provide a DCP version for theatrical screening.

IF YOU SUBMIT YOUR FILM, YOU AGREE WITH THE FOLLOWING RULES

WORKS

Works must fulfilled the corresponding submission requirement.

SCREENING

The festival programming team reserves the right to assign selected films to the most appropriate screening section.

COPYRIGHT & INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

By submitting your film, you affirm that you are the rightful owner of the work and have obtained all necessary rights, clearances, and permissions for all content within it, including but not limited to music, visuals, and the likeness of any real individuals (e.g., actors, public figures).

AI-generated content used in submissions should respect third-party copyright and intellectual property rights. All submissions must be original works created by the entrant.

The organisation team is not liable for any copyright infringements conducted by the entrant, and any conflicts should be resolved by the parties involved.

The festival organisers reserve the right to disqualify and remove any submissions that violate these rules or any applicable laws.

GRANT OF RIGHTS

By submitting your film and associated materials (including but not limited to the video file, PDF documentation, trailer, stills, and poster, collectively "the Submission Materials"), you grant the organisation team a non-exclusive, worldwide, royalty-free license to use the Submission Materials for the following purposes:

Screening: To showcase the film during the AI Film Festival and any associated events.

Promotion: To use portions of your film (e.g., clips, trailers), stills, and posters for promotional purposes on social media, the official website, press releases, and other relevant platforms.

Education & Archives: To use the Submission Materials for educational purposes and to archive them as part of the festival's historical records.

Academic Research: To analyse, study, and use the Submission Materials (specifically including the PDF documentation detailing the AI creation process) for non-commercial academic research. This includes, but is not limited to, the creation and publication of academic papers, reports, articles, and presentations that cite, describe, or analyse the submitted works. In all such academic uses, the Festival will ensure that you are credited as the creator of the work.

SUBMISSION CONFIRMATION

By submitting your film, you confirm that you have read, understood, and agreed to all the rules and terms set forth in this document. You warrant that you have the full right and authority to grant the rights outlined herein.

TECHNICAL SPECIFICATIONS

Initial Submission (for selection purposes):

- Video format: MP4 or MOV,
- Resolution: 1080p,
- Codec: H.264,
- Audio: Stereo,
- Subtitles: Burned-in subtitles.

If Selected for Official Screening:

Selected films may be required to provide a DCP version for theatrical screening.

DCP technical specifications:

- Image Size: HD, Full, Flat or Scope (2K or 4K),
- Encoding: JPEG 2000,
- Bitrate: ≤ 500 MBit/s,
- Frame rates: 24 fps, 25 fps, 30 fps, or 60 fps,
- SMPTE and INTEROP DCP are all acceptable.